Student Activities Association
Budget Committee / Board of Directors Meeting Thursday, October 1, 2020 at 1:40PM

BUDGET COMMITTEE AGENDA (9 members, Quorum: 5)

Chairperson

Amber Rivero, President, Student Government
Ellen Hartigan, Interim Vice President of Student Affairs
Mark Flower, Interim Vice President & Chief Operation Officer, Finance and Administration
Andrew Berezhansky, Vice President, Student Government
Saaif Alam, Treasurer, Student Government
Aileen Luna, Secretary, Student Government
Maia Farina, Senior Representative, Student Council
Faculty Member

a. Approval of Budget Committee items

b. Approval of Budget Committee minutes from August 31, 2020

c. SAA Treasurer Report

d. Approval of 23 Club Budgets:

Student Organization	Budget Amount
ASLA	196.00
Artists United	119.40
BSU	1,568.00
Food Security Advocates	992.00
Graphic Novels Club	1,100.00
HASA	180.00
Hillel	620.98
H4H	913.04
ICJ	309.00
IWJA	30.00
ISA	1,423.02
JJ Productions	1,225.65
La Voz	597.60
Law Society	300.00
Legally Conscious	824.03

LGBTQ+ and Allies	1,459.20
LWT	291.80
MPASA	993.87
Muslim Students Association	6,000.00
UI	968.29
Veteran's Association	2,263.88
TOTAL:	**22,375.76**

e. Approval of Essential Services budgets
John Jay Sentinel 2020-2021 budget: $10,733.63
Theatrical Players 2020-2021 budget: $3,812.21
United Nations Student Association 2020-2021 budget: $11,595.71

f. Approval of Student Council 2020-2021 budget: $167,507.29

g. Approval of Earmarks:
Center for Student Involvement and Leadership (CSIL) 2020-2021 budget: $72,634.43
Orientation 2020-2021 budget: $66,151.99
Military and Veterans Service 2020-2021 budget: $17,562.00
Quality of Life 2020-2021 budget: $27,724.32

h. Association Administration 2020-2021 budget: $208,006.59

i. Surplus update

j. Reserve request: $1,355,000.00

k. New Business

BOARD OF DIRECTORS AGENDA (13 members, Quorum: 7)

Chairperson	Ellen Hartigan, Interim Vice President of Student Affairs
SAA Secretary	Michael Martinez-Sachs, Assistant Vice President and Dean of Students
	Mark Flower, Interim Vice President & Chief Operation Officer, Finance and Administration
	Amber Rivero, President, Student Government
	Andrew Berezhansky, Vice President, Student Government
	Saaif Alam, Treasurer, Student Government
	Aileen Luna, Secretary, Student Government
	Maia Farina, Senior Representative, Student Council
	Katelynn Seodarsan, Junior Representative, Student Council
	Elizabeth Yukins, Faculty Member
	Jean-Marie Col, Faculty Member
	Lisa-Marie Williams, Business Manager (non-voting)

a. Approval of Board of Director agenda items

b. Approval of Board of Director minutes from August 31, 2020

c. Acceptance of the Budget Committee Report

d. Social media position update

e. Surplus requests

f. Conflict of Interest statements

g. New business

Student Activities Association
Budget Committee/Board of Directors Meeting
SAA Budget Committee Minutes – Thursday, October 1, 2020
1:40PM, Zoom

Presiding Chair: Amber Rivero, President, Student Government

Recording Secretary: Rachel Brown

Members
Ellen Hartigan, Interim Vice President of Student Affairs
Mark Flower, Interim Vice President & Chief Operation Officer, Finance and Administration
Andrew Berezhansky, Vice President, Student Government
Aileen Luna, Secretary, Student Government
Maia Farina, Senior Representative, Student Council
Jean-Marie Col, Faculty Member

Guests/Non-voting Members Present: Jeffrey Aikens, Jasmine Awad, Ingrid Cabanilla, Mark Francis, Laura Ginns, Nikki Gupton, Makeda Jordan, Amanda Martinez , Iris Martinez, Michael C. Martinez-Sachs, Richard Pusateri, Jon Salamak, Katelynn Seodarsan, Rama Sudhakar, Lisa-Marie Williams, Elizabeth Yukins

Order: SAA Budget Committee Meeting was called to order at 1:39PM by Amber Rivero. Quorum was achieved.

Motion #1: Motion to approve Budget Committee Agenda items – Andrew Berezhansky
Second: Jean-Marie Col
Vote: Favor [6] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Motion #2: Motion to approve August 31, 2020 meeting minutes– Mark Flower
Second: Ellen Hartigan
Vote: Favor [6] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Discussion of Treasurer's Report: The Chief Financial Administrative Officer of the Student Activities Association gave a report on the current financial status of the SAA to the Budget Committee. The Committee discussed the budgeting process. Currently, entities request the funds they need, and the Board votes on their approval. Any un-requested funds go into surplus. There was

discussion about an alternate budgeting process, where the Board would allocate funds to entities to spend appropriately, and any unspent funds from those allocations would go into surplus.

There are additional concerns that the budget requests from student clubs and organizations are too small, due to pandemic conditions restricting the clubs' ability to put on their normal programs. Some Board members feel this will result in a very large surplus fund, and would prefer to allocate more funds to student clubs and organizations now instead of putting the funds into surplus. Other Board members feel that increasing the funds given to student clubs isn't a useful practice, as there is no way for the clubs to spend the additional funds given the limitations of remote learning and campus closures.

Motion #3: Motion to approve 23 Club Budgets individually – Ellen Hartigan
Second: Jean-Marie Col
Action: Motion rescinded

Motion #4: Motion to approve 23 Club Budgets as a slate – Ellen Hartigan
Second: Jean-Marie Col
Vote: Favor [6] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Motion #5: Motion to approve slate of 23 Club Budgets totaling $22,375.76 – Ellen Hartigan
Second: Andrew Berezhansky
Vote: Favor [6] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed
Discussion: The Committee had concerns about the small budget requests put in by some of the clubs. They discussed the difficulties of club programming in pandemic conditions, as students cannot gather and serve refreshments for events or meetings. They also discussed the possibility of allocating funds to more urgent student needs.

Motion #6: Motion to increase 23 Club Budgets an additional 50% above their original approved requests – Mark Flower
Second Ellen Hartigan
Vote: Favor [5] Opposed [1] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed
Discussion: The Committee had concerns about spending funds before they went into the surplus fund. There are more opportunities for student clubs to submit budgets to the Committee on Clubs for the semester. The Committee determined it was better to allocate funds now rather than wait for students to request them, in the interests of making the process easier for students and spending the money sooner.

Motion #7: Motion to approve Essential Services budgets as a slate – Ellen Hartigan
Second: Andrew Berezhansky
Vote: Favor [6] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Motion #8: Motion to approve slate of Essential Services budgets totaling $26,141.55– Andrew Berezhansky

Second: Jean-Marie Col
Vote: Favor [6] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Motion #9: Motion to increase 3 Essential Services budgets an additional 50% above their original approved requests – Ellen Hartigan
Second: Andrew Berezhansky
Vote: Favor [5] Opposed [0] Abstained [1]
Action: Motion passed
Discussion: Essential Services are capped at a certain percentage, based on the referendum. There are concerns that increasing the budgets by 50% will place them over the cap. There are also concerns that increasing budgets for this meeting is not equitable to the entities who had their budgets approved at the August 31 meting without increases.

Motion #10: Motion to increase budgets approved at the August 31, 2020 meeting an additional 50% above their original approved requests – Mark Flower
Second: Andrew Berezhansky
Vote: Favor [5] Opposed [0] Abstained [1]
Action: Motion passed
Discussion: The Committee decided to increase the budgets from the August 31 meeting, to remain equitable.

Motion #11: Motion to approve Student Council budget totaling $167,507.29 – Andrew Berezhansky
Second: Ellen Hartigan
Vote: Favor [6] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Motion #12: Motion to Motion to increase Student Council budget an additional 50% above their original approved request – Andrew Berezhansky
Second: Ellen Hartigan
Vote: Favor [6] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Motion #13: Motion to approve Earmark budgets as a slate – Ellen Hartigan
Second: Jean-Marie Col
Vote: Favor [6] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Motion #14: Motion to approve slate of Earmark budgets totaling $184,072.74 – Andrew Berezhansky
Second: Mark Flower
Vote: Favor [6] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed
Discussion: Members from the Center for Student Involvement and Leadership answered Committee questions regarding Orientation and Quality of Life activities in pandemic conditions. Both budgets include virtual programming and mailing promotional items to students.

Motion #15: Motion to approve Association Administration budget totaling $208,006.59 – Ellen Hartigan
Second: Aileen Luna
Vote: Favor [6] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Discussion of surplus fund: There is currently about $2.5 million dollars in the surplus fund. The Board needs to vote on a process by which to solicit surplus proposals. The Board can also vote to place some of the surplus funds in reserve, either for a specific purpose or for contingencies. There is an item on the agenda for a reserve request, but there are concerns that the amount being requested is greater than is allowed according to the fiscal accountability handbook. There are also concerns that placing too much money in reserve will make it difficult to access if the funds are needed for another purpose. The discussion was tabled due to lack of time.

Motion #16: Motion to approve Reserve request totaling $1,355,000.00 – Andrew Berezhansky
Second: Aileen Luna
Action: Motion rescinded

Motion #17: Motion to table Reserve request agenda item for next meeting – Andrew Berezhansky
Second: Ellen Hartigan
Vote: Favor [6] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Motion #18: Motion to continue to pay employees through the next Board meeting – Andrew Berezhansky
Second: Ellen Hartigan
Vote: Favor [5] Opposed [0] Abstained [1]
Action: Motion passed
Discussion: The reserve request was tabled until the next meeting due to lack of time. To ensure that all employees continue to get paid, the Committee voted to approve the portion of the reserve request that goes toward employee salaries.

Meeting adjourned at 3:11PM

Approval:

Amber Rivero, Chair, Budget Committee_____

Student Activities Association
Budget Committee/Board of Directors Meeting
SAA Board of Directors Minutes – Thursday, October 1, 2020:

Presiding Chair: Ellen Hartigan, Interim Vice President of Student Affairs

Presiding SAA Secretary: Michael Martinez-Sachs, Assistant Vice President and Dean of Students

Recording Secretary: Rachel Brown

Members Present: Mark Flower, Interim Vice President & Chief Operation Officer, Finance and Administration
Amber Rivero, President, Student Government
Maia Farina, Senior Representative, Student Council
Katelynn Seodarsan, Junior Representative, Student Council
Elizabeth Yukins, Faculty Member
Jean-Marie Col, Faculty Member

Guests/Non-voting Members Present: Jeffrey Aikens, Jasmine Awad, Ingrid Cabanilla, Mark Francis, Nikki Gupton, Makeda Jordan, Iris Martinez, Richard Pusateri, Jon Salamak, Lisa-Marie Williams

Order: SAA Board of Directors Meeting was called to order at 3:11PM. Quorum was achieved.

Motion #1: Motion to approve Board of Directors Agenda items – Michael Martinez-Sachs
Second: Katelynn Seodarsan
Vote: Favor [7] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Motion #2: Motion to approve August 31, 2020 meeting minutes – Michael Martinez-Sachs
Second: Mark Flower
Vote: Favor [7] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Motion #3: Motion to accept Budget Committee report – Michael Martinez-Sachs
Second: Jean-Marie Col
Vote: Favor [7] Opposed [0] Abstained [0]
Action: Motion passed

Agenda item D) Social media position update, and item E) Discussion of surplus request process, tabled due to lack of time.

Meeting adjourned at 3:16PM

Approval:

I.V.P. Ellen Hartigan, Chair, Board of Directors _____

Michael Martinez-Sachs, Secretary, Board of Directors_____

From: Amber Rivero
To: Ellen Hartigan; Michael Sachs
Cc: Rachel Brown; Michael Lee; Lisa-Marie Williams
Subject: RE: 10/01 SAA BOD minutes for approval
Date: Monday, October 19, 2020 10:58:12 AM

Approved.

Best Regards,

Amber Rivero (she/her/hers)
President of John Jay College Student Council
John Jay College of Criminal Justice
Mobile: (347)-701-6161

" If a man does not keep pace with his companions, perhaps it is because he hears a different drummer. Let him step to the music which he hears, however measured or far away."
Henry David Thoreau

From: Ellen Hartigan
Sent: Friday, October 16, 2020 1:19 PM
To: Michael Sachs
Cc: Rachel Brown; Amber Rivero; Michael Lee; Lisa-Marie Williams
Subject: Re: 10/01 SAA BOD minutes for approval

Approved.

Ellen Hartigan
Interim Vice President for Enrollment Management and Student Affairs
John Jay College of Criminal Justice

Sent from my iPhone

> On Oct 16, 2020, at 1:18 PM, Michael Sachs <msachs@jjay.cuny.edu> wrote:
>
> Approved
>
> Michael
>
> > On Oct 16, 2020, at 12:31 PM, Rachel Brown <rabrown@jjay.cuny.edu> wrote:
> >
> > Hello,
> >
> > Attached are the minutes for the SAA BOD meeting. There is some confusion about Motion 10 in the Budget Committee meeting, as to which of the 8/31 budgets were approved for a retroactive 50%

increase.

In the interests of student clubs getting their approved budgets and holding their events/programming, the suggestion is to approve this version of the minutes but not implement Motion 10 until a re-vote of the motion can be held at November 5 SAA BOD meeting.

If this is acceptable, please email your approval of the minutes in lieu of signature on the document.

Sincerely,
--
Rachel Brown
Student Relations Manager
<image001.jpg>

Office of the Dean of Students
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New York City, NY 10019
Main: 212.621-4143
Fax: 646-557-4508

<2020.10.01 SAA BOD Minutes.pdf>